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THE PEGRAMS OF DINWIDDIE AND SOME ASSOCIATED FAMILIES

An article in Tyler's Quarterly (43) entitled "Dr. James Greenway, eighteenth Century Botanist of Dinwiddie County, with account of two generations of his descendants", States that: "Dinwiddie County, at the close of the eighteenth century had numerous gentlemen who lived in considerable style on their plantations." It named individual families, including the PEGRAM family, the Boisseau, Dabney, Scott, Gregory, Mason, Hardaway and other families. The Pegrams married into all of these families.

The Southside Virginia News of Petersburg published an article, 16 February 1967, entitled, "Bonneville Plantation Rich in History," which included exterior and interior photographs of this historic Pegram home. This was the Dinwiddie plantation home built by Major General John Pegram^s about 1800. It is stated that "probably no family exceeded the early Pegrams in prominence." Virginia and Southern history carry the names of many members of the family.

"Upon my word and honor" — "Virginia gentlemen of Dinwiddie County, Virginia as I knew them sixty five years ago"; written by Thomas H. Boisseau for the *Index-Appeal* of Petersburg, Virginia about 1867 (41).

They were peculiar people unto themselves, educated as they were from early youth to be polite to all, intimate to few. They were wealthy, educated and aristocratic in their bearing, but easily approached.

Upon my word and honor, was a term used by all of them, and never violated; they met as friends; conversed as friends and parted as friends; confident that nothing that had been said would be repeated, knowing as they did how good and pleasant it is for friends to dwell together in unity.

The name Pegram is listed among the old and leading families in Eastern Virginia, in colonial times and immediately succeeding the Revolution (44).

The sparse Dinwiddie County population of white males, age 16 and up, in 1790 belied their great influence, not only in Dinwiddie County, but in Virginia and the Nation. The 1790 census shows only 1790 free white males, 16 and up, 1396 free white males under 16, 2853 free white females, 561 all other free persons and 7,334 slaves, for a total population of 13,934. Slightly more than one half of the population was slaves.

INTER-RELATIONSHIPS BETWEEN THE PEGRAMS AND SOME OTHER DINWIDDIE COUNTY FAMILIES

Thomas H. Boisseau's description of the "Aristocratic" families of Dinwiddie portrays in a few words the kind of people they were, but who were these families? No attempt will be made to introduce but a few of them, but some knowledge of whom families associate with and marry, certainly adds to their characterization. Richard L. Jones (40) in his history of Dinwiddie County lists 90 old plantation homes, and includes illustrations of many that are still in existence. Most of these were originally built, or lived in, by the principal families of Dinwiddie County. The gentle rolling hills of Dinwiddie must

have been especially productive to have generated so many wealthy plantation owners. The families also appear to have been of sturdy stock and good heritage to have produced so many successful descendants. Many were successful in business and government, and Dinwiddie seems to have provided more than its share of officers in all of this country's wars. The following were families that were closely associated with the Pegrams, and married into that family.

THE SCOTT FAMILY — Of all the families in Virginia, the Scott family was more intimately associated with the Pegrams than any other. There were numerous marriages between them. Four of the children of Edward Pegram⁴ married Scotts, and there were others that will be discussed later. Both the Pegram and Scott families married into the Hardaway family. There were apparently two Scott families in Dinwiddie. Thomas Scott had a patent for 770 acres of land before the arrival in Dinwiddie of James Scott in 1746 (40). James was said to have married a Pegram (41), presumably Sarah³, the daughter of Daniel Pegram², and his wife Sarah. James Scott had a son William⁴ who married Ann Mason. Two of William and Ann's children, Col. James Scott⁵ and Rebecca Scott⁵ married grandchildren of Edward Pegram³. Another child was Gen. Winfield Scott, previously discussed. It was this latter Scott family (James Scott being the progenitor), that was so closely associated with the Pegrams.

AN ANCIENT MANSION — The following article, somewhat abbreviated, appeared in a Richmond, Virginia newspaper of 1 February 1867, and was transcribed by Susan Wright Pegram (45).

The ancestral summer residence of that noble hero, Gen. Winfield Scott, has my attention been recently called, and a much desired interest been awakened to become familiar with its history. . . . The mansion was built about 120 years since, (which would have made its construction about 1747) in some antiquated style of English architecture, which has almost entirely disappeared, being nearly remodeled by modern additions. The Pegram family, whose name was familiar in the late war (1865), were intimately connected by marriage with this Scott family, and it is supposed the mansion was originally built by them and afterwards inherited by the Scotts through marriage, being used conjointly as convenient, for both families as a summer residence. About 1868 it was purchased by Mr. J. Hill Smith of Richmond, but the portion to which I allude as being the residence of General Scott is still in possession of a son of the General who could never be induced to part with it. The farm adjoins and is in full view of Dinwiddie Courthouse, hence the name "Village View", and presents a most charming appearance. The house in a commodious antique building . . . surrounded by every kind of farm building, ornamented by groves, springs and orchards. . . . Immediately in the rear . . . is the family burying ground of the Scotts . . . securely walled in with granite in a manner of old English tombs. In this are deposited the remains of the ancestors of the General and his relatives. . . . The famous Diamond Springs is in a beautiful grove, in the diamond field on this property was the grand scene in the olden times and even during the years of the succession, many imposing political gatherings, barbecues, picnics, and other summer amusements of the gentry of this and neighboring Counties, etc. . . . The battle of Five Fork, one of the last decisive battles of the war was fought on a portion of this farm.

Diamond Springs was the home of Edward Pegram⁴, who died there in 1816. Martha Pegram⁵, one of the four daughters of Edward⁴, married Col. James Scott, brother of Winfield.

Susan Wright Pegram (Mrs. Robert Baker Pegram III) visited Diamond Springs in 1930, and made an interesting report of her observations.

The Works Progress Administration of Virginia Historical Inventory (46) gave a history and description of "Village View" in 1936. At that time all that remained was the stone foundation, the chimney and part of the framework. The house originally owned by the Pegrams, remained in the family until 1828, when it was sold by John C. Pegram to William H. Goodwyn, who sold it to John W. Gilliam in 1840. Several more sales ensued, and the property belonged to W.F. Stearne of Dinwiddie, in 1936. The Works Progress Administration workers dated "Village View" about 1775, which is somewhat later than the date indicated by the Richmond newspaper's article of 1867.

THE EPPES FAMILY were wealthy landowners and prominent residents of Dinwiddie County. Isham Eppes and his brother John were sons of William Eppes and the grandsons of Francis Eppes II, who died in 1678. The latter was the son of Francis Eppes the immigrant, 1597-1655. The Eppes were prominent as officers in the Revolutionary War, and in the governmental affairs of the county and state. The family home "Eppington" was one of the most magnificent homes in Virginia. Sallie Pegram, daughter of Edward Pegram³ and Mary Scott Baker, married Daniel Eppes, and there were other marriages between the families. The Eppes name has been brought down in the family to the twentieth century. It is presently spelled Epes and Epps, as well as Eppes. A town in West Central Alabama bears the Epes name.

THE GILLIAM FAMILY were French Huguenots of Norman Descent, who appeared in Dinwiddie, along with others of that faith, such as the Boisseaus, Burdons and Cousins. Thousands of Huguenots migrated to Virginia to escape punishment in France, and to have freedom of religion. Most of them came about the turn of the eighteenth century, but some came much earlier. Although Virginia was settled almost exclusively by the English, during the eighteenth century some of the French Huguenots became leading citizens of Dinwiddie County. Edward Pegram⁵, son of Daniel Pegram⁴, and grandson of Edward³ and Mary Scott Baker, married Dorothy Gilliam. The Gilliam family is discussed in more detail in the chapter on Edward Pegram⁵, and Dorothy Gilliam.

THE HARDAWAY FAMILY was closely associated with the Pegrams. Daniel Pegram⁴, son of Edward³ and Mary Scott Baker, married Nancy Hardaway. They are discussed in chapter 19. The Hardaways lived in the Driver and Hardaway homes, both described in the "History of Dinwiddie County" by Jones (40). Nancy Hardaway's mother was Agnes Thweatt, The Thweatt homes were "Ridgeway", "Shell House" and "Denmark". Daniel and Nancy are the direct ancestors of the particular line being followed and are discussed in depth later. Robert Pegram⁵, son of Capt. Edward Pegram⁴, married Mary Simmons Hardaway.

THE HARGRAVE FAMILY was another distinguished one of Dinwiddie County. Private academies were the principal means of secondary education during most of the nineteenth century. Dinwiddie County had a number of these. James Hargrave was the headmaster of the Quaker School for Boys. One of his early pupils was Winfield Scott, later to become famous as a militarist and statesman. Pegram Academy was founded as a school for young ladies by Mrs. Mary E. Pegram. The Hargraves were prominent in the Civil War. The Hargrave Blues formed Company I of Dinwiddie County. Henrietta Pegram⁶, daughter of Col. Robert Pegram⁵ and Mary Simmons Hardaway, married the Reverend Isham E. Hargrave.

THE BOISSEAU FAMILY is prominently connected with the history of Dinwiddie County, and was closely associated with the Pegrams. "Tudor Hall" was the home of William Boisseau. The original structure was built in 1775, but was enlarged in 1832, and again in 1852. The house, which stood near the Union Sixth Corps siege line, served as a hospital during the campaign. Blood stains of wounded soldiers are said to still be present on the attic floor (40). Tudor Hall is still occupied. The exterior of the large two story house is still of original design. The Boisseau family also lived at "Aspen Hill"; the Adolphus Boisseau home since 1878.

The Boisseaus were in Dinwiddie about the time of the arrival of the Pegrams. James Boisseau patented land in 1739 and 1757. Holmes Boisseau patented land adjoining that of the Thweatt, Taylor and Eppes families in 1745. James Boisseau, an Assemblyman in the Virginia Assembly, voted in favor of secession on 17 April 1861. It passed the Assembly 88 to 55. The Boisseau family was influential in business, political and military affairs of the area.

David Boisseau married Sarah Pegram⁵, daughter of George Pegram⁴, and granddaughter of Edward³.

THE MANSON FAMILY left their name to the Manson United Methodist Church in Dinwiddie. The church was founded in 1815 and was believed named for Dr. Frank Manson, a Methodist minister of the area. The Mansons were an influential family of the area. Major Baker Pegram⁴ (DAR 41775), son of Edward Pegram³ and Mary Scott Baker, married Mary Manson in 1775.

THE WARD AND GREGORY FAMILIES — The first Seth Ward was a planter of Varina, Henrico County, Virginia. He was there about 1634. A son Benjamin of “Sheffield”, who died in 1732, married Mary Anderson, daughter of Henry Anderson. Their son Col. Seth Ward, Justice of Henrico County, and member of the House of Burgesses, was the father of Mary Ward, born in 1749. She first married William Broadnax, and then Richard Gregory. Mary and Richard were the parents of Martha Ward Gregory, who married Gen. John Pegram of Dinwiddie County in 1800, and there were other marriages between the families.

Another indication of associated families is suggested by the following amusing item: John R. Thompson succeeded Edgar Allan Poe as Editor of the Southern Literary Magazine in 1847. Thompson was a great society man. His special friends were the Pegrams, Standards, Cabells, Rutherfords, Mumfords, Andersons, Mansons and people of that ilk (47).

Other prominent and early Virginia families that were associated and intermarried with the Pegrams were the Parhams, the Dabneys, and the Sturdivants.

There are a number of Pegram plantation homes in Dinwiddie County. “Bonneville”, built by Maj. Gen. John Pegram about 1800 is one of the best known, and presently occupied, Figure 6. It will be discussed in more detail later. “Diamond Springs”, previously considered, was the home of Edward Pegram⁴. “Edgefield” was the home of Maj. Edward “Fighting Ned” Pegram⁵, son of Capt. John Pegram. “Woodlawn” was the home of John Pegram Jr., “Jack-my-dandy” Pegram⁵, a brother of “Fighting Ned”. Col. Robert Pegram⁵, son of Edward⁴, who married Mary Simmons Hardaway, built “Weiland”, as his home, Figure 15. It is about three miles southeast of Dinwiddie Village.

The old garden and family graveyard, without markers, are in back of the house. Col. Robert Pegram died 16 April 1824 and is buried there along with his wife. Henrietta Pegram⁶, daughter of Col. Robert, married Isham E. Hargrave, and she inherited “Weiland” following the death of her father (97). The house has been altered a number of times and has lost most of its original appearance, Figure 3 shows the location of some of the Pegram homes in Dinwiddie County.

PEGRAM SQUARE — In the old Blanford Church Cemetery in Petersburg, there is an area known as Pegram Square. Here are buried a number of descendants of the owners of the previously discussed Pegram homes. Some of those buried there are as follows: Lucy B. Cargill, wife of the noted Capt. Robert Baker Pegram⁶, and their daughter Lucy Cargill Pegram⁷; Richard Gregory Pegram Jr.⁷, son of Richard Gregory Pegram and Jane Brichett; Blair Burwell Pegram⁸, son of Richard G. Jr. and Helen Burwell Pegram. There are a number of other Pegrams buried in Pegram Square, as well as a host of relatives including the Holts, the Romaines, the McIlwaines, the Deas, the Cuthberts and others. A record of the tombstone inscriptions was recently made by Mr. Robert L. Pegram of Dallas, Texas.

